



GigLine
SAFETY & COMPLIANCE

2026 EDITION

The Triad OSHA Field Manual

What Piedmont Triad Manufacturers
Get Cited For — And How to Fix It

7 violations. Real findings. Plain language.
Written for the owner who is also
the safety officer.

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"Most small manufacturers in the Piedmont Triad don't have a compliance problem. They have a visibility problem. The hazards are there. Nobody has walked the floor and called them by name yet."

Introduction

Why This Manual Exists

I have walked a lot of floors in the Piedmont Triad. Manufacturing facilities, fabrication shops, warehouses, distribution centers, rubber and window operations. Small companies — 10 people, 30 people, 50 people — where the owner writes the checks, manages the production schedule, and is also the default safety officer.

What I find on almost every walk is not negligence. It is not indifference. It is the gap between what's required and what's known. The OSHA standards are not written in plain language. The penalty tables are not posted next to the equipment. And nobody is walking the floor looking for violations the way an inspector will.

This manual covers the seven violations I see most consistently in Triad manufacturing and warehouse operations. For each one, I have included the CFR citation, what it looks like on the floor, what I have personally observed, the penalty range, and the fix. Nothing generic. No filler.

The goal is simple: you read this, you walk your floor, you find the gaps before OSHA does. If you want someone to walk it with you, that's what GigLine does.

Proverbs 27:12 — "A prudent person foresees danger and takes precautions. The simpleton goes blindly on and suffers the consequences."

How to use this manual: Each finding section stands alone. You can read straight through or jump to the violations most relevant to your operation. The CFR citations are exact — you can look up any standard at [osha.gov](https://www.osha.gov) for the full regulatory text.

01 Machine Guarding

Machine guarding is OSHA's most cited manufacturing violation — and the one most likely to cost someone a hand before it costs the company a fine. The standard is straightforward: any machine part, function, or process that may cause injury must be guarded. In practice, that means point-of-operation guards, nip points, rotating parts, flying chips, and sparks all need to be addressed. The problem is that guards get removed for maintenance and never go back on. Or the original equipment never had adequate guarding to begin with.

CFR CITATION

29 CFR 1910.212 — General Machine Guarding

WHAT THIS MEANS ON THE FLOOR

Guards missing, removed, or bypassed on presses, grinders, conveyors, and cutting equipment. Point-of-operation hazards left exposed during normal production.

WHAT I SAW

Press line with the point-of-operation guard removed — operators running parts with hands in the danger zone. The guard had been taken off weeks earlier to clear a jam and never replaced. Nobody flagged it. Nobody stopped production.

PENALTY RANGE

\$16,131 per violation — up to \$161,323 per willful or repeat citation

THE FIX

Audit every machine on the floor. Replace or reinstall missing guards before the next shift. Create a lockout/tagout step that prevents equipment from running without guards in place. Document the inspection. Train operators to report missing guards — not work around them.

02 Lockout/Tagout (LOTO)

LOTO violations kill people. When equipment is being serviced or maintained, unexpected energization — electrical, hydraulic, pneumatic, mechanical — is one of the leading causes of workplace fatalities in manufacturing. OSHA requires a written energy control program, machine-specific procedures for every piece of equipment, and documented annual inspections of those procedures. Most small manufacturers have a generic LOTO policy buried in a binder. That does not meet the standard.

CFR CITATION

29 CFR 1910.147 — Control of Hazardous Energy

WHAT THIS MEANS ON THE FLOOR

No written LOTO program, no machine-specific procedures posted at equipment, no documented annual inspections, no employee training records.

WHAT I SAW

Facility with 12 pieces of powered equipment and one generic LOTO poster on the wall. No machine-specific procedures. Employees performing maintenance with power still energized — they said that's how it had always been done. Three of those employees couldn't describe what LOTO was.

PENALTY RANGE

\$16,131 per violation — frequently cited as willful at \$161,323

THE FIX

Write a facility-specific LOTO program. Develop individual energy control procedures for each machine — post them at the equipment, not in a binder. Train every affected employee. Document the training. Conduct and document an annual inspection of each procedure with a certified review. This is not optional and it is not a one-time fix.

03 Pinch Points & Unguarded Nip Points

Pinch points exist wherever two objects move together and at least one rotates. Conveyors, rollers, gear drives, chain drives, belt drives — all create nip points that can pull in fingers, hands, and clothing faster than a person can react. These are often overlooked because the machine is "running fine" and the hazard is not obvious until something goes wrong.

CFR CITATION

29 CFR 1910.212(a)(1) — *Point of Operation Guarding*

WHAT THIS MEANS ON THE FLOOR

Exposed nip points on conveyors, rollers, and drive components with no guarding or inadequate guarding that does not prevent contact.

WHAT I SAW

Conveyor system with exposed roller nip points at the feed end — no guard, no warning label. An operator's glove had caught and been pulled through six months earlier. The guard had never been installed. The near-miss was never recorded.

PENALTY RANGE

\$16,131 per violation

THE FIX

Identify every nip point, pinch point, and rotating part on the floor. Install OSHA-compliant guards — they must prevent employee contact, not just discourage it. If a guard cannot be installed on a particular machine, document the engineering review and implement administrative controls and PPE as a secondary measure.

04 Trip Hazards & Walking Surfaces

Slips, trips, and falls are the second leading cause of workplace injuries in manufacturing — and they are almost entirely preventable. OSHA's standard is basic: floors must be clean, dry, and free of hazards. Aisles and passageways must be kept clear. The challenge is that these conditions deteriorate gradually and employees stop seeing them.

CFR CITATION

29 CFR 1910.22 — General Housekeeping and Walking Surfaces

WHAT THIS MEANS ON THE FLOOR

Cords, hoses, and materials crossing walkways. Uneven or damaged flooring. Aisles blocked by equipment or inventory. No visual demarcation of walking paths in production areas.

WHAT I SAW

Extension cords running across main production aisle — taped down with duct tape, which is not a compliant fix. Pallet debris in marked egress path. Two floor drains with damaged grating creating a step hazard at a high-traffic crossing point.

PENALTY RANGE

\$16,131 per violation

THE FIX

Walk your facility with fresh eyes — or have someone walk it who did not build the layout. Mark aisle boundaries with floor tape or paint. Establish a daily housekeeping standard with assigned responsibility. Repair damaged flooring immediately. Eliminate extension cords as permanent wiring solutions.

05 Lockout/Tagout Procedures Not Posted

Having a LOTO program is not the same as having LOTO procedures that employees can actually use. The standard requires written procedures for each machine that has more than one energy source or where the shutdown sequence is not obvious. Those procedures must be accessible to the employees who use them — which means posted at or near the equipment, not in an office binder.

CFR CITATION

29 CFR 1910.147(c)(4) — *Energy Control Procedure Documentation*

WHAT THIS MEANS ON THE FLOOR

Machine-specific LOTO procedures exist in documentation but are not posted at the equipment. Employees servicing machines have no procedure to reference at the point of task.

WHAT I SAW

Facility with a written LOTO program in the safety office — three-ring binder, well organized. Zero procedures posted on the production floor. Maintenance technician performing a die change could not locate the procedure for that press. He was doing it from memory.

PENALTY RANGE

\$16,131 per violation — cited alongside the program deficiency

THE FIX

Print and laminate machine-specific procedures. Mount them at each piece of equipment — on the machine or on a nearby post within arm's reach of the lockout point. Update them any time the machine is modified. This is a 30-minute fix per machine that closes a citation that costs more than \$16,000.

06 Outdated Fire Extinguisher Inspections

Fire extinguisher compliance is one of the most straightforward items on an OSHA checklist — and one of the most commonly missed. The standard requires monthly visual inspections, annual maintenance inspections, and documentation of both. It also requires that extinguishers be accessible, unobstructed, and properly mounted. In practice, the tags go unsigned, the inspections get skipped, and nobody notices until an inspector pulls one off the wall.

CFR CITATION

29 CFR 1910.157(e) — *Portable Fire Extinguishers*

WHAT THIS MEANS ON THE FLOOR

Fire extinguisher inspection tags unsigned, out of date, or missing. No documentation of annual maintenance. Extinguishers blocked by equipment or inventory.

WHAT I SAW

Twelve extinguishers in a 40,000 sq ft facility — nine had tags with the last signed monthly inspection dated 14 months prior. Two were blocked by raw material stacked in front of them. One had a broken pressure gauge and had not been flagged for service.

PENALTY RANGE

\$16,131 per violation — multiple extinguishers means multiple citations

THE FIX

Assign one person to inspect all extinguishers on the first business day of every month. Sign and date the tag. Schedule annual third-party maintenance and keep the service records on file for three years. Remove any obstructions within 18 inches of each unit. This takes 20 minutes a month.

07 OSHA 300 Log & Recordkeeping Not Posted

Employers with 11 or more employees in most manufacturing industries are required to maintain OSHA injury and illness records and post the Form 300A annual summary from February 1 through April 30 every year — even if there were zero recordable incidents. The 300 log must be retained for five years. Failure to post or maintain these records is a paperwork violation that carries real penalties and signals to OSHA that your recordkeeping program deserves a closer look.

CFR CITATION

29 CFR 1904.32 — Annual Summary Posting Requirement

WHAT THIS MEANS ON THE FLOOR

OSHA Form 300A annual summary not posted during the required February–April window. Form 300 log not maintained, incomplete, or not retained for five years. Management signature missing from the 300A.

WHAT I SAW

February walkthrough at a 22-person fabrication shop — no 300A posted anywhere in the facility. Owner did not know the requirement existed. They had experienced two recordable injuries the prior year, neither of which had been logged.

PENALTY RANGE

\$16,131 per violation — failure to record and failure to post are separate citations

THE FIX

Set a calendar reminder: February 1, post the signed 300A in a visible location accessible to all employees. Maintain your Form 300 throughout the year — log every recordable injury or illness within seven days of learning about it. Retain all records for five years. If you have had injuries you did not record, address it now before an inspection forces the issue.

Before OSHA Shows Up

Your Next Step

If you read this manual and recognized your operation in any of these findings, that recognition is the first step. The second step is doing something about it before someone else forces your hand.

An OSHA inspection is not scheduled. A recordable injury does not wait for a convenient time. The citations in this manual carry penalties starting at \$16,131 per violation — and inspectors do not walk a floor looking for one thing. They walk the whole floor.

A GigLine Safety Walkthrough gives you a documented picture of where you stand before anyone else is looking. One visit. A written report. A ranked list of what to fix first — RED, AMBER, GREEN. Delivered within 24–48 hours.

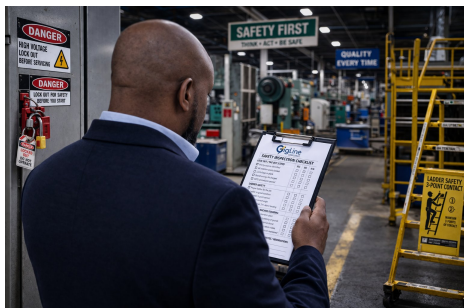
Your operation has gaps. Find them before OSHA does.

Schedule a Safety Walkthrough & Top 10 Fixes Report. Starting at \$650. No retainer. No contract.

giglinecompliance.com/request-walkthrough (336) 329-8899

No retainer. No contract. No ongoing obligation. One engagement, one report, your call on what happens next.

About the Author



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I started GigLine Safety & Compliance to serve the kind of operation I spent most of my career working inside — small manufacturers and warehouses where the owner is running everything and safety gets handled between production runs. These businesses do not need a retainer. They need someone to walk the floor, call things by name, and hand them a list they can actually work from.

GigLine operates in the Piedmont Triad region of North Carolina. Every engagement is direct — you work with me, not a coordinator. Every report is written, documented, and delivered within 48 hours.

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